

Heart Health — Mini Guide (Test PDF)

Overview

Hypertension (high blood pressure) is a major risk factor for heart disease and stroke. In 2023, the World Health Organization (WHO) estimated that hypertension affects 1.28 billion adults worldwide.

Key Conditions

- Hypertension is defined as systolic ≥ 140 mmHg or diastolic ≥ 90 mmHg (clinic measurement).
- Atherosclerotic Cardiovascular Disease (ASCVD) includes coronary artery disease and stroke.

Treatments (examples)

- Lisinopril (an ACE inhibitor) treats hypertension and helps reduce cardiovascular risk.
- Atorvastatin (a statin) lowers LDL cholesterol, reducing ASCVD events.

Guidelines & Organizations

- The American Heart Association (AHA) recommends lifestyle changes (salt reduction, exercise ≥ 150 minutes/week) for adults with elevated BP.
- The WHO reports global prevalence and publishes policy guidance for population-level BP control.

Risk & Monitoring

- Smoking increases the risk of heart disease and stroke.
- Home BP monitors should be validated devices and used after 5 minutes of rest.

Simple Facts (for relations)

- Lisinopril → treats → Hypertension
- Atorvastatin → lowers → LDL cholesterol
- AHA → recommends → Lifestyle changes
- WHO → reports → Hypertension prevalence
- Smoking → increases risk of → Heart disease

References

- WHO. Hypertension fact sheet, 2023.
- AHA. 2022/2023 guidance on BP management.